



MIKOMI JAPANESE LANGUAGE INSTITUTE

Katakana Practice Workbook

カタカナ れんしゅうちょう

JLPT N5 · ABSOLUTE BEGINNER

Prepared by **Mikomi Japanese Language Institute**
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Learn Japanese. Unlock Global Opportunities.

Start Here はじめに

Welcome to Katakana — the second Japanese script! If you've finished Hiragana, you already know how this works: each character is one sound. Katakana shares the same 46 sounds, just with sharper, more angular shapes. You'll see it everywhere in modern Japan.

◆ What is Katakana?

Katakana (カタカナ) is used mainly for **foreign loanwords** (like コーヒー, coffee), foreign names, onomatopoeia, and for emphasis — a little like italics in English. It represents exactly the same 46 sounds as Hiragana, so if you know one, learning the other is much faster. The shapes are more angular and made of straighter lines.



How this workbook is organised

1. The complete Katakana chart · 2. Stroke-order guides · 3. Guided writing practice · 4. Reading exercises · 5. A mini quiz to test yourself.



How to practise well. Say each sound aloud as you write it. Follow the stroke order shown — correct order makes your writing faster and more natural. Trace the light-grey guides first, then write freely in the blank squares. Just 15 minutes a day works wonders.



A gentle goal. Aim to recognise all 46 basic characters within two weeks. Don't rush — consistency beats speed. Mikomi is with you at every step of the journey.

WHERE YOUR JAPANESE JOURNEY BEGINS

◆ The Five Vowels — your foundation

Every katakana sound is built from just five vowel sounds. Learn these first:

ア

A

like "a in father"

イ

I

like "ee in see"

ウ

U

like "oo in food"

エ

E

like "e in bed"

オ

O

like "o in more"

REFERENCE

The Katakana Chart 五十音図

The gojūon ("fifty sounds") – the complete set of 46 basic characters. Read row by row, saying each sound aloud. This is your master map.

◆ Basic Characters • 46 sounds

	A	I	U	E	O
A	ア A	イ I	ウ U	エ E	オ O
K	カ KA	キ KI	ク KU	ケ KE	コ KO
S	サ SA	シ SHI	ス SU	セ SE	ソ SO
T	タ TA	チ CHI	ツ TSU	テ TE	ト TO
N	ナ NA	ニ NI	ヌ NU	ネ NE	ノ NO
H	ハ HA	ヒ HI	フ FU	ヘ HE	ホ HO
M	マ MA	ミ MI	ム MU	メ ME	モ MO
Y	ヤ YA		ユ YU		ヨ YO
R	ラ RA	リ RI	ル RU	レ RE	ロ RO
W	ワ				ヲ

REFERENCE

Voiced & Combined Sounds 濁音・拗音

Once you know the basics, these are easy add-ons. A small " (dakuten) or ° (handakuten) mark changes the sound. Combining with small やゆよ makes the blended "yōon" sounds.

◆ Dakuten & Handakuten • voiced sounds

	A	I	U	E	O
G	ガ GA	ギ GI	グ GU	ゲ GE	ゴ GO
Z	ザ ZA	ジ JI	ズ ZU	ゼ ZE	ゾ ZO
D	ダ DA	ヂ JI	ヅ ZU	デ DE	ド DO
B	バ BA	ビ BI	ブ BU	ベ BE	ボ BO
P	パ PA	ピ PI	プ PU	ペ PE	ポ PO

◆ Yōon • combined sounds

	YA	YU	YO
	キャ KYA	キュ KYU	キョ KYO
	シャ SHA	シュ SHU	ショ SHO
	チャ CHA	チュ CHU	チョ CHO

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 1 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your writing look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

ア A · 2 strokes アメリカ (amerika) <i>America</i>	イ I · 2 strokes インク (inku) <i>ink</i>
ウ U · 3 strokes ウール (uuru) <i>wool</i>	エ E · 3 strokes エアコン (eakon) <i>air conditioner</i>
オ O · 3 strokes オレンジ (orenji) <i>orange</i>	カ KA · 2 strokes カメラ (kamera) <i>camera</i>
キ KI · 3 strokes キー (kii) <i>key</i>	ク KU · 2 strokes クラス (kurasu) <i>class</i>
ケ KE · 3 strokes ケーキ (keeki) <i>cake</i>	コ KO · 2 strokes コーヒー (koohii) <i>coffee</i>
サ SA · 3 strokes サラダ (sarada) <i>salad</i>	シ SHI · 3 strokes シャツ (shatsu) <i>shirt</i>
ス SU · 2 strokes スープ (suupu) <i>soup</i>	セ SE · 2 strokes セーター (seetaa) <i>sweater</i>
ソ SO · 2 strokes ソファ (sofa) <i>sofa</i>	タ TA · 3 strokes タクシー (takushii) <i>taxi</i>

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 2 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your writing look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

チ CHI · 3 strokes チーズ (chiizu) <i>cheese</i>	ツ TSU · 3 strokes ツアー (tsuua) <i>tour</i>
テ TE · 3 strokes テレビ (terebi) <i>television</i>	ト TO · 2 strokes トマト (tomato) <i>tomato</i>
ナ NA · 2 strokes ナイフ (naifu) <i>knife</i>	ニ NI · 2 strokes ニュース (nyuusu) <i>news</i>
ヌ NU · 2 strokes スードル (nuudoru) <i>noodle</i>	ネ NE · 4 strokes ネクタイ (nekutai) <i>necktie</i>
ノ NO · 1 stroke ノート (nooto) <i>notebook</i>	ハ HA · 2 strokes ハンバーガー (hanbaagaa) <i>hamburger</i>
ヒ HI · 2 strokes ヒーター (hiitaa) <i>heater</i>	フ FU · 1 stroke フォーク (fooku) <i>fork</i>
ヘ HE · 1 stroke ヘリコプター (herikoputaa) <i>helicopter</i>	ホ HO · 4 strokes ホテル (hoteru) <i>hotel</i>
マ MA · 2 strokes マスク (masuku) <i>mask</i>	ミ MI · 3 strokes ミルク (miruku) <i>milk</i>

STROKE ORDER

How to Write — Part 3 書き順

Correct stroke order makes your writing look natural and flow quickly. In Japanese, we generally write top-to-bottom and left-to-right. Each character below shows its stroke count and an example word to practise reading.

 MU · 2 strokes ムード (muudo) <i>mood</i>	 ME · 2 strokes メニュー (menyuu) <i>menu</i>
 MO · 3 strokes モデル (moderu) <i>model</i>	 YA · 2 strokes タイヤ (taiya) <i>tyre</i>
 YU · 2 strokes ユニット (yunitto) <i>unit</i>	 YO · 3 strokes ヨガ (yoga) <i>yoga</i>
 RA · 2 strokes ラジオ (rajio) <i>radio</i>	 RI · 2 strokes リボン (ribon) <i>ribbon</i>
 RU · 2 strokes ルール (ruuru) <i>rule</i>	 RE · 1 stroke レストラン (resutoran) <i>restaurant</i>
 RO · 3 strokes ロボット (robotto) <i>robot</i>	 WA · 2 strokes ワイン (wain) <i>wine</i>
 WO · 3 strokes ヲ (wo) <i>(rarely used)</i>	 N · 2 strokes パン (pan) <i>bread</i>



You now know all 46! Watch out for look-alikes — ソ/シ、ク/ケ. The stroke direction is what tells them apart, so following stroke order really matters here. Turn the page to start writing.

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 1 (Vowels & K · S)

れんしゅう

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

ア ^A	ア	ア						
イ ^I	イ	イ						
ウ ^U	ウ	ウ						
エ ^E	エ	エ						
オ ^O	オ	オ						
カ ^{KA}	カ	カ						
キ ^{KI}	キ	キ						
ク ^{KU}	ク	ク						
ケ ^{KE}	ケ	ケ						
コ ^{KO}	コ	コ						
サ ^{SA}	サ	サ						

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 2 (T · N · H) れんしゅ

う

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

シ SHI	シ	シ	シ					
ス SU	ス	ス	ス					
セ SE	セ	セ	セ					
ソ SO	ソ	ソ	ソ					
タ TA	タ	タ	タ					
チ CHI	チ	チ	チ					
ツ TSU	ツ	ツ	ツ					
テ TE	テ	テ	テ					
ト TO	ト	ト	ト					
ナ NA	ナ	ナ	ナ					
ニ NI	ニ	ニ	ニ					

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 3 (M • Y • R) れんしゅ

う

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

ヌ	ヌ	ヌ						
ネ	ネ	ネ						
ノ	ノ	ノ						
ハ	ハ	ハ						
ヒ	ヒ	ヒ						
フ	フ	フ						
ヘ	ヘ	ヘ						
ホ	ホ	ホ						
マ	マ	マ						
ミ	ミ	ミ						
ム	ム	ム						
メ	メ	メ						

PRACTICE

Writing Practice — Part 4 (W • N & Review)

れんしゅう

Trace the light guides first, then write each character on your own. Say the sound aloud as you go. The dotted cross-lines help you balance each character in the square.

モ MO	モ	モ						
ヤ YA	ヤ	ヤ						
ユ YU	ユ	ユ						
ヨ YO	ヨ	ヨ						
ラ RA	ラ	ラ						
リ RI	リ	リ						
ル RU	ル	ル						
レ RE	レ	レ						
ロ RO	ロ	ロ						
ワ WA	ワ	ワ						
ヲ WO	ヲ	ヲ						
ン N	ン	ン						

Reading Exercises よみましょう

Now put it together! Read each word aloud, sound by sound, then check the romaji and meaning. Cover the right side first and test yourself.

◆ Read these words

コーヒー → koohii · coffee

テレビ → terebi · television

カメラ → kamera · camera

ホテル → hoteru · hotel

タクシー → takushii · taxi

パン → pan · bread

ミルク → miruku · milk

ケーキ → keeki · cake

レストラン → resutoran · restaurant

アメリカ → amerika · America

インターネット → intaanetto · internet

ジュース → juusu · juice



Great work! Notice the — mark — it lengthens the vowel before it (コーヒー = ko-o-hi-i).
Loanwords are everywhere in Japan, so reading Katakana unlocks menus, signs and shops instantly.

TEST YOURSELF

Mini Quiz ミニテスト

Time to check your progress! Write the romaji (English sound) for each character below. No peeking — answers are at the bottom of the page.

◆ Part A • Write the romaji

1 ア

2 キ

3 ス

4 ネ

5 ハ

6 モ

7 ュ

8 ル

9 ヲ

10 ン

◆ Part B • Which character makes this sound?

1 KA

2 SHI

3 TSU

4 NO



おめでとう！

Congratulations on finishing!

You now know both Hiragana and Katakana — the complete Japanese sound system! This is a huge milestone. With these two scripts you can already read a surprising amount. Next stop: building your vocabulary and meeting your first kanji. We're right here with you.

READY FOR VOCABULARY & KANJI? · JOIN MIKOMI

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